5.3.4.1 Types of Blues

Depending upon their solubility in water, blues are classified into two categories:

1. Insoluble Blues

   Do not form clear solution in water. e.g., Ultramarine and Persian blue.

2. Soluble Blues

   When dissolved in water, form clear solutions. e.g. Coal-tar dyes, methyl violet and methylene blue.

5.3.4.1.1 Insoluble Blues

- **Ultramarine Blue**

This is more commonly used laundry blue. It can be safely used on the fabrics. This does not have any harmful effect. It is made from chemicals like, soda ash, sodium sulphate, charcoal, sulphur and clay. It is available as a fine powder which forms an even micro-suspension in water.

- **Persian Blue**

This is not commonly used. This is undesirable as it is formed from iron sulphate and potassium ferrocyanide. This gives rusty marks when the treated fabric is ironed.

5.3.4.1.2 Soluble Blues

All the soluble blues are chemical dyes. These are available in large number of varieties. These are employed in commercial laundries. These are preferred in laundries because insoluble blues, produce an even colour and leave no sediment.

5.3.4.2 Bluing Process

Bluing is done as the last rinse of the fabric after washing. For this purpose care should be taken that no soap is left in the fabric before bluing. The blue is tied in a muslin cloth and squeezed in cold water until the required colour in water is obtained. The articles are dipped in the solution once or twice, taking care that after taking out no solution is left filling in pockets or bag shaped parts. The blued fabric is then squeezed off to remove excess solution and dried.

5.3.5 Drying Equipments

The washed clothes can be dried conveniently under direct sun rays when sufficient open space is available. The lack of open area in urban areas has stressed the need for other appliances. These appliances can be used for drying of clothes in limited space, as well as in rainy seasons. The commonly used appliances under such situations are;



Figure 5.17 Foldable Drying Rack

5.3.6 Outdoor Drying

Cloth Line or Cord and Clips

This is a simple rope or cord made of galvanised iron, plastic, hemp or coconut fibres etc. It is tied at the two ends. The air as it moves across the clothes, draws away the cloth moisture till they are dried. The cloth line should be of sufficient length

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